

OnePlus Buds Pro 2

Classy and massy

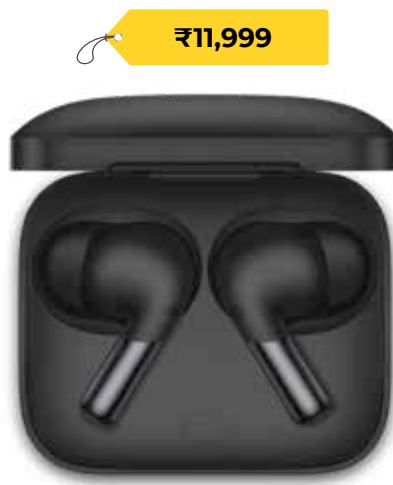
It's been two years since OnePlus launched its flagship TWS product – the OnePlus Buds. Now, the much-awaited successor is here and is dubbed OnePlus Buds Pro 2 and to reclaim its “Pro” moniker, OnePlus has packed it with a plethora of features. From a new dual driver setup to a Dynaudio collaboration to Spatial Audio, these buds seemingly have it all. However, features alone do not make a pair of earphones worth your hard-earned money. So, does it stand up to the competition it faces in its price bracket? Let's find out.

BUILD, DESIGN, AND FIT

The OnePlus Buds Pro 2 have a simplistic and classy design. The case is extremely similar to the last generation one with a couple of nuanced changes. It is a sleek matte-finish case that can fit into pockets and purses with ease. The top houses a simple OnePlus logo and Dynaudio branding. However, it cannot be opened one-handed with ease, which is slightly disappointing. Additionally, the matte surface can also get scratched and scuffed easily over prolonged usage, so we'd recommend you to exercise some caution about where you store the case. The overall build feels pretty robust but the case's lid is slightly flimsy since it isn't secured by metal. The buds have pressure-sensitive controls, which worked like a charm. We've always preferred pressure-sensitive controls over traditional touch controls. As for comfort, the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 fit nicely in the ear. They are also quite lightweight.

FEATURES

The OnePlus Buds Pro 2 are absolutely brimming with features. Sadly, some of these features are restricted to OnePlus users and some are even restricted merely to OnePlus 11 users. We are not fans of this approach. The latest addition to the earphones is Spatial Audio support. It is only supported on the OnePlus 11 for now,



but on its website, OnePlus promises that it will be supported by more models “in the near future”. The buds come with Dual Connection which worked quite flawlessly on an Android phone and Windows laptop. There's also Google Fast Pair support that allows for super fast pairing. OnePlus has also added 54 ms low-latency mode, but that's a feature limited to a couple of OnePlus phones only. Now, let's move on to the HeyMelody app, which is a tried and tested app, and with custom options being added for the Buds Pro 2 it works better than ever.

PERFORMANCE

The original OnePlus Buds Pro featured dual 11mm dynamic drivers which delivered good, punchy sound but it didn't really match up to other heavyweights of the time. The sound is slightly more balanced than the OG OnePlus Buds Pro and the separation is MUCH better. LHDC codec supports hi-res, low-latency audio which has nearly three times the data transfer rate of conventional SBC. While being more balanced sounding than the original ones, still have a warm, U-shaped sound signature that highlights the bass and highs. However, due to the significant boost in bass, there is

auditory masking in the mids that mutes out some of the detail in vocals and lead instruments. The earbuds sound good with genres such as rap, pop, hip hop, EDM, and Bollywood. But for podcasts and the classical genre of music, we'd suggest you to look elsewhere. The microphone performance, on the other hand, is something that impressed us greatly. It has definitely improved over the original OnePlus Buds Pro. The voice of the speaker is heard clearly and it doesn't sound muffled or distant.

BATTERY LIFE

We tested the earbuds with AAC active and ANC turned on and we got 5.5 hours on the earbuds and 22 hours in total with the charging case. If you turn off

ANC, the earbuds will last you much longer. However, the improvement in battery life is miniscule which is disappointing. The earbuds also come equipped with Qi wireless charging support which is pretty sweet.

VERDICT

The OnePlus Buds Pro 2 is quite a solid upgrade over the original Buds Pro. These are the epitome of classy and mass-y earphones. While the sound signature is far more balanced comparatively, the auditory masking in the mids means that audiophiles and purists should steer clear of these earphones. However, if you're a bass-lover and are looking for feature rich earbuds, the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 is a good choice. If you're a OnePlus user, it is an even better choice!

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 11 mm woofer + 6 mm tweeter dual drivers | Frequency response: 10 Hz - 40kHz | Microphones: 3 (per side) | ANC: Yes, up to 48 dB | Audio codecs: LHDC, AAC, SBC, LC3 | Bluetooth version: 5.3 | IP Rating: IP55 (earbuds), IPX4 (case) | Battery life: 9 hours (earbuds), 39 hours (earbuds + case) with ANC off and AAC

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